

1. About Northwind Coffee Roasters

Northwind Coffee Roasters was founded in 2009 as a two-person operation working out of a rented commissary kitchen. Today the company employs thirty-one people across the roastery, the cafe and the wholesale team. This handbook is the internal reference for anyone answering customer questions, whether over email, on the phone or at the counter.

Our sourcing model is direct trade. We buy from eleven producer partners across Ethiopia, Colombia, Guatemala and Sumatra, and we publish the price paid per pound of green coffee for every lot we buy. Contracts are signed annually in October and cover the following harvest year.

Roasting happens on a 12 kilogram Loring Smart Roast. Every batch is logged: charge temperature, development time, and end temperature. Batch logs are retained for three years and are available to any wholesale partner on request.

2. Ordering and fulfilment

Retail orders are placed through the website and are picked the same day they are roasted. The roast schedule runs Tuesday through Saturday, so an order placed on Sunday enters the Tuesday roast.

Wholesale orders are placed by the account manager through the partner portal. The minimum wholesale order is twenty pounds per shipment and may be mixed across origins. Wholesale invoices are net thirty.

Subscription orders renew on the same calendar day each month. A customer may pause, skip or cancel a subscription at any time before the renewal date without penalty. A paused subscription is never billed and does not count against the annual loyalty tier calculation.

Shipping is calculated by weight, not by order value. Orders over fifty dollars ship free within the continental United States.

3. Quality control

Every lot is cupped twice: once on arrival as green coffee, and once forty-eight hours after roasting. Cupping scores are recorded on the SCA hundred point scale. We do not release any lot scoring below eighty-four.

Moisture content of green coffee is measured on arrival and must fall between ten and twelve percent. Anything outside that band is rejected and returned to the importer at their cost.

Water used in the cafe and on the cupping table is filtered and remineralised to a target of one hundred and fifty parts per million total dissolved solids. The filter cartridges are replaced every ninety days.

Grinders are calibrated at open and at close. Burr sets are replaced after six hundred kilograms of throughput, which for the cafe is roughly annually.

4. Returns, refunds and the satisfaction guarantee

Northwind operates under return policy PX-820. Under return policy PX-820 a customer may return any unopened retail bag within 45 days of the delivery date for a full refund, and we pay the return shipping. The 45 day window under PX-820 applies to retail orders only.

Opened bags are covered by the separate satisfaction guarantee: if a customer does not like the coffee, we replace it once with a different origin at no charge. There is no requirement to return the opened bag.

Wholesale returns are handled case by case by the account manager and are not covered by PX-820. Damaged shipments must be reported within seven days of delivery, with photographs, and are replaced rather than refunded.

Refunds are issued to the original payment method and take three to five business days to appear. Gift card purchases are non-refundable but never expire.

5. The cafe

The cafe is attached to the roastery and shares its ventilation, which is why the espresso bar closes for twenty minutes during any roast that runs past two in the afternoon.

Opening hours are seven in the morning until three in the afternoon on weekdays, and eight until two at weekends. The cafe is closed on New Year Day, Thanksgiving and Christmas Day.

The espresso menu is deliberately short: espresso, macchiato, cortado, flat white, latte. There is no flavoured syrup on the menu and there has not been since 2014. Oat, soy and whole milk are offered at no price difference.

Staff are trained on a four week rotation covering brewing, extraction theory, milk technique and customer service. Every new hire cups with the quality team in their first week.

6. Sustainability and packaging

Retail bags are LDPE 4 with a polypropylene one-way valve. Both are accepted by the Seattle curbside recycling program. Wholesale coffee ships in five pound kraft bags with a recyclable liner.

Spent grounds from the cafe are collected daily by an urban farm cooperative. In 2024 that diverted just over eleven tonnes from landfill.

The roastery runs on a hundred percent renewable electricity contract. The roaster itself is gas fired; we offset its emissions through a verified reforestation programme and publish the certificates annually.

Our long term goal is a fully compostable retail bag. We have tested four candidate materials and none has yet held a twelve month shelf life, so we have not switched.